

YUNHO KIM

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Academic Motivation, Intervention Development, MTSS, Family-School-Community Collaboration, Coaching

EDUCATION

Kwangwoon University | Seoul, Republic of Korea Feb 2024

M.S. in Industrial Psychology (Coaching Psychology)

GPA: 4.05/4.50 | Research-group scholarship (partial tuition)

- Master's thesis: *A Study on the Effectiveness of a Grit-Enhancement Group Coaching Program for Upper Elementary School Students*.

Advisor: Jin Kook Tak, Ph.D.

Kwangwoon University | Seoul, Republic of Korea Feb 2020

B.S. in Industrial & Organizational Psychology with an Interdisciplinary Major in Leadership Coaching | National Scholarship (Full Tuition)

Bachelor's Degree Examination for Self-Education | Republic of Korea Feb 2018

B.A. in English Literature

Degree earned through Korea's government-administered national degree examination pathway.

PUBLICATIONS AND SCHOLARLY PRODUCTS

Kim, Y. (2024). *A Study on the Effectiveness of a Grit-Enhancement Group Coaching Program for Upper Elementary School Students* [Master's thesis, Kwangwoon University]. [RISS](#) | [DBpia](#)

Kim, Y., Kim, C., Kang, C., & Kang, M. (2019). *Development of a Happiness Habit Scale* [Departmental research paper]. *Research in Industrial and Organizational Psychology*, 26, 150–158. Kwangwoon University, Department of Industrial Psychology. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22944190>

Kim, Y. (2025). *Memorial Night: Pet Loss Syndrome (추모의 밤: 펫로스 증후군)* [eBook]. ISBN 979-11-982644-0-4. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.22899851>

Role: Supervising Counselor & Researcher; Yul Choi, Jimin Sung, and Seojin Lee served as research assistants.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Kwangwoon University | **Master's Thesis Researcher** 2022-2024

- Designed and implemented a seven-session group coaching intervention, including participant recruitment, pilot testing, program refinement, and two-week follow-up assessment.
- Structured the comparison condition to differ from the intervention in only two sessions, isolating the contribution of a targeted program component.
- Applied a three-group quasi-experimental design (experimental, comparison, control; $N = 24$) and conducted reliability analyses, one-way ANOVA (baseline equivalence), paired and independent t tests, and mixed ANOVA using SPSS; grit showed a significant group-by-time improvement, while self-directed learning effects were not significant.

Kwangwoon University | **Undergraduate Researcher** 2019

- Co-developed the Happiness Habit Scale, beginning with a 26-item pool and analyzing data from 163 young adults; conducted item analysis, internal-consistency analysis, and exploratory factor analysis using SPSS, resulting in a 15-item, three-factor measure (Agency, Positive Perception of Adversity, and Interpersonal Relationships).
- Evaluated the scale's reliability and criterion-related validity; the initial 26-item measure demonstrated Cronbach's $\alpha = .808$ and a significant positive association with the Satisfaction With Life Scale ($r = .399, p < .001$).

Kwangwoon University | **Undergraduate Researcher** 2019

- Investigated whether perspective-taking and internal vs. external attribution increase multicultural acceptance among young adults ($N = 108$); co-designed a 2×2 between-subjects experiment with a posttest-only control group design, chosen to reduce demand characteristics.
- Analyzed data using two-way ANOVA in SPSS; neither manipulation produced significant main or interaction effects, whereas gender differences in multicultural acceptance were significant. As first author of the unpublished research report, identified unclear stimulus materials and high data exclusion as key limitations.

Pet Loss Syndrome Support Project | **Researcher & Program Developer** 2022–2025

- Conducted a literature review and semi-structured interviews with individuals who had experienced and recovered from pet loss, followed by structured individual and focus group interviews to identify their support needs.
- Designed and delivered a needs-based psychoeducational support program grounded in these findings, under the supervision of a Ph.D.-level clinical psychologist.

PRESENTATIONS AND ACADEMIC EXCHANGE

National Taiwan Normal University (NTNU) Academic Exchange, Taipei | **Presenter** Aug 2024

- Presented master's thesis research in English and participated in a small-group academic exchange with doctoral students, faculty, and researchers in education and educational psychology.

- Presented master's thesis research on the effectiveness of a grit-enhancement group coaching program for upper-elementary school students.

PROFESSIONAL AND APPLIED EXPERIENCE**Sky-Dream Coaching Psychology Center | Academic Coach & Youth Counselor**

Feb 2022–Present

- Plan, coordinate, and deliver school- and community-based psychological support projects in partnership with social welfare centers, schools, and local education offices, from program design and grant-funded implementation to assessment and outcome evaluation (see Poom Family Project, Green Friends School, and Youth Mentoring Project below).
- Provide individual counseling and academic coaching for children and adolescents addressing academic motivation, school adjustment, emotional concerns, and goal setting.
- Conduct psychological assessment batteries, including K-WISC-V and other standardized measures, with administration, scoring, interpretation, feedback, and written reports; consult with caregivers on individualized support plans.

Digital Game-Based Academic Motivation Program | Program Developer

2026–Present

Digital adaptation of the Hwanggok Elementary School Academic Motivation Enhancement Program | Ongoing pilot

- Adapting the academic motivation program originally developed for Hwanggok Elementary School into a game-based web program, so that students in rural schools without school-based counseling services (Wee Class), or in schools served by a single counselor, can access it more easily.
- Piloting the program in collaboration with elementary school teachers; a formal outcome evaluation is in preparation.

Poom Family Project | Psychological Homecare Planner

Jan–Dec 2025

Family Function Enhancement Project for Vulnerable Children and Adolescents | Sky-Dream Coaching Psychology Center x Gimpo 2nd Comprehensive Social Welfare Center | Funded by Community Chest of Korea

- Provided home-based coaching and family-strengthening services, including parent education, for 50 elementary and middle school students from vulnerable families, including single-parent, grandparent-led, multicultural, and North Korean refugee-background households.
- Coordinated wraparound supports (meal assistance, educational materials, multicultural-language education, and referrals to clinical mental health services) with the Gimpo Education Support Office, Gimpo Family Center, Child Protection Agency, Foreign Residents Support Center, and community childcare centers.
- Supported program planning and pre/post outcome evaluation; participants showed gains in self-direction, self-efficacy, and peer-play relationships, and 81% showed observed improvement in peer relationships.

Green Friends School | Assistant Instructor & Project Management Assistant

Nov 2025

Cognitive Coaching Group Program | Sky-Dream Coaching Psychology Center x Gimpo 2nd Comprehensive Social Welfare Center | Funded by Community Chest of Korea

- Assisted in coordinating and delivering a five-session group program for seven middle school students with borderline intellectual functioning, targeting emotional awareness and expression, communication, self-understanding, and adaptive functioning.
- Co-administered pre/post BGT, KFD, and HTP; post-program observations showed more sustained attention, task completion, and response consistency.

Education Office-Supported Youth Mentoring | Psychological Assessment & Mentoring Coach

Jun 2025

Collaboration with a local Education Office, Gimpo Social Welfare Center, and Sky-Dream Coaching Psychology Center

- Provided brief mentoring and structured card-based conversations on emotions and needs for two adolescents with borderline intellectual functioning, including one out-of-school youth.
- Administered BGT, HTP, KFD, and J-TCI and prepared individualized psychological evaluation reports integrating interviews, behavioral observation, assessment findings, and support recommendations.

Hwanggok Elementary School | Program Developer & Lead Instructor

May 2025

Academic Motivation Enhancement Program | Independent engagement commissioned by the school

- Commissioned directly by the school to independently design and deliver a four-module, activity-based program for a third-grade class targeting self-directed learning, academic motivation, learning barriers, and individualized learning strategies; developed the curriculum and original instructional materials.
- Provided school consultation following a student–teacher conflict, integrating a game-based anxiety measure, personality screening, and classroom observation into a psychological report to inform student support and classroom planning.

Pet Loss Syndrome Support Project | Project Manager & Instructor

2022–2025

- Managed an annual psychoeducational support program for individuals grieving the loss of a companion animal, including program planning, group facilitation, volunteer coordination, and grief-support materials.
- Integrated research findings on grief, attachment, and coping into program materials and an ISBN-registered eBook (see Publications).

Kwangwoon Coaching Psychology Institute x "Cool Summer Night" | Psychological Coach

2023

- Provided six-session, strengths-based coaching to five adult clients as one of 33 graduate-level coaches (103 clients; PHQ-9-screened intake) in partnership with a psychology content creator.

- Coached two first-year students admitted through equity-focused admission tracks (six 1:1 sessions) as one of 15 coaches; the program showed significant pre/post gains in self-direction, self-efficacy, and college adjustment ($n = 29$, all $p < .01$).

TEACHING AND MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Private English & Academic Tutoring | Tutor 2016-Present

- Provide individualized English grammar, reading, and writing instruction to more than 20 students, primarily those with low academic motivation or disengagement from English learning, including students with ADHD or borderline intellectual functioning (diagnosed or suspected).
- Tailor pacing, repetition, task structure, and scaffolding to each student's learning needs.

Gangbuk Youth Center After-School Program | Guest Instructor Sep-Dec 2023

- Facilitated psychology-based after-school activities for approximately 20-30 youth participants.

Kyungwon Middle School After-School Program | Instructor Sep 2022-Dec 2023

- Used guitar instruction and mentoring to engage students at risk of school avoidance, emphasizing persistence, confidence, and positive school participation.

SELECTED PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Korean Coaching Psychology Association Summer Conference | Attendee Aug 2026

CNC Cognitive-Behavioral Research Institute Seminar | Participant Feb 2024-Feb 2026

- Topics included adolescent development, academic counseling, learning competency assessment, and ecological approaches

Korean Coaching Psychology Association Summer Conference | Attendee Jun 2024

Korean Coaching Psychology Association Winter Conference / Fall Special Lecture | Attendee Feb 2023 / Nov 2022

CERTIFICATIONS AND SPECIALIZED TRAINING

Clinical Psychologist, Level 2 – National Qualification, Republic of Korea Feb 2022

Youth Counselor, Level 3 - National Qualification, Republic of Korea Feb 2022

COYAD (Community Youth Against Drugs) Instructor Program (English-medium) - Completed Jan 2025

TCI Training - Basic and Intermediate Levels Dec 2023 / May 2024

Coaching Psychologist Certification Training - Completed Jul 2022

SERVICE AND MILITARY EXPERIENCE

Teacher and Mentor for Elementary and Middle School Students | Church Volunteer Aug 2024-Present

- Teach and mentor elementary- and middle-school-aged students in a group setting and provide supportive guidance related to academic, emotional, and behavioral concerns.

Seoul Juvenile Classification Review Center (Anyang) | Cultural-Arts Volunteer Performer Jun & Nov 2025

- Participated in two outreach performances for justice-involved adolescents through band ensemble and original-song performance, storytelling, and an on-camera interview emphasizing resilience, reflection, and positive future orientation.
- Contributed to a collaborative program organized by the Ministry of Justice and Miracle OK Language Institute, a nonprofit association.

Seocho Mabul Hero Supporters | Drug Prevention Supporter 2025

- Contributed to youth drug-prevention campaigns through Seocho District's Mabul Hero initiative, the first youth drug-prevention supporters program launched by a local government in South Korea.

Republic of Korea Army | Peer Counselor Sep 2020-Sep 2021

- Provided peer-based emotional support and guidance to fellow soldiers, helping peers navigate personal stressors and connect with appropriate support when needed.

SELECTED COMMUNITY IMPACT AND MEDIA COVERAGE

Seoul Juvenile Classification Review Center Cultural-Arts Outreach Jun/Nov 2025

- Performances covered by [LawIssue \(Jun 20\)](#), [The AsiaN \(Jun 22\)](#), [Kyeongin Ilbo \(Jun 22\)](#), and [The AsiaN \(Nov 28\)](#).

Seocho Mabul Hero Supporters Apr-Oct 2025

- Drug-prevention initiative covered by [Seocho Times \(Apr 7\)](#), [Seoul Ilbo \(Apr 6\)](#), [Seocho Shinmun \(Apr 5\)](#), [Sun News \(Apr 4\)](#), [Yonhap News Agency \(Apr 4\)](#), and [OBS News \(Apr 3\)](#).

Pet Loss Syndrome Support Project | Featured in two Kuki News articles [Jan 31](#) & [Feb 2, 2024](#)

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: Korean (Native); English (Professional working proficiency).

Personal Interests: Guitar, Songwriting, Soccer, and Traveling

Professional Memberships:

- Korean Psychological Association — Member
- Korean Coaching Psychology Association — Member
- Korean School Psychology Association — Member
- Korean Clinical Psychology Association — Member

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Quantitative Methods: SPSS; reliability analysis; exploratory factor analysis; independent- and paired-samples *t* tests; one-way, factorial, mixed, and repeated-measures ANOVA

Qualitative Methods: semi-structured interviews; focus group interviews; needs assessment

Applied Assessment: Administration, scoring, and interpretation of cognitive, personality, and projective measures under supervision (K-WISC-V, MMPI-2, MMPI-A, TCI, HTP, KFD, SCT); behavioral observation; integrated report writing

Program Development: Design, implementation, and outcome evaluation of youth counseling and coaching programs; group facilitation; caregiver coaching; school- and community-based prevention supports